



The River Nile in Egypt

The Nile floods

Each year, the River Nile flooded and spread rich, black soil on its banks. Farmers grew crops in the soil and used the river water to water their fields.



Nile barges were important for transport.

Hieroglyphics

The Egyptians used picture writing called hieroglyphics. Symbols, such as those below, stood for letters and sounds.



Hieroglyphic sound chart

			
ah	b	c, k	d
			
ee, y	f	g	h
			
kh	m	n	p
			
r	s	t	oo, u, w

The Sphinx

A huge stone statue, called the Sphinx, guards the pyramids at Giza. It has the body of a lion and a human head, which was modelled on the pharaoh's own features.

The great Sphinx guards the pyramid of a pharaoh called Khafra.

The mysterious Sphinx still stares out across the desert.